



PLANNING AS A MANAGEMENT

DEFINITION

- looking ahead and preparing the organization for the future course of actions
- Planning involves the setting of objectives (what to do), formulation of a strategy (how to do) and implementation of strategy (when, whom) to achieve the set objectives.
- foresee, examining the future, deciding what needs to be achieved and developing a plan of action.



IMPORTANT ELEMENTS

- Mission – purpose of organizations' existence
- Objectives – quantifiable statement of intent
- Strategies – Broad based plan of action
- Tactic – means by which strategies are implemented
- Policies – general guidelines for decisions and actions



IMPORTANCE

- Planning Provides Direction
- Provides a sense of purpose
- Provides a basis for control
- Motivation



CONT...

- Economic importance/ maximise resource utilization /Planning Reduces Overlapping and Wasteful Activities
- Foresee future problems - Planning Reduces Risks of Uncertainty
- Planning Promotes Innovative Ideas



PROCESS

- Opportunity analysis
- Setting objectives
- Establishing planning premise
- Identifying Strategic alternatives
- Evaluation of alternatives
- Support plan and budget
- Implementation
- Monitoring and evaluation



LIMITATIONS

- Human inability
- Uncertainty
- Lack of data
- Rigidity
- Resources availability



PRINCIPLES

- Based on clearly defined roles
- Take inconsideration the existing organisation
- Should provide a basis for controls
- Take note of factors in the environment that could affect the plans success
- Simple to implement
- Be flexible to necessitate change



TYPES

- Strategic
- Tactical
- Operational
- Contingency

- Short term
- Intermediate
- Long term

